

C920

Contemporary Curriculum Design and Development in Nursing Education

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
-----------------------------	---	------------------------	----------------------------------

Items

1.

A faith-based nursing school with a scenic campus has a mission that emphasizes service to rural and underserved communities. A faculty committee, meeting in the newly renovated library, is designing a new BSN elective. Which design choice best reflects the mission?

- A. Design around topics faculty most enjoy teaching.
- B. Focus only on licensure test-taking strategies.
- C. Build in content and clinical experiences with rural and underserved populations.
- D. Feature the scenic campus in course marketing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A curriculum team at a college that recently added a parking deck is building a new maternal-newborn course. The team leader, who has 20 years of labor and delivery experience, wants to start by choosing favorite case studies. Under backward design, what should the team do first?

- A. Write the exams.
- B. Define the desired learning outcomes.
- C. Use the leader's favorite cases because of her experience.
- D. Pick the learning activities and case studies.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team has finished writing its course outcomes. In backward design, what comes next?

- A. Choose a textbook.
- B. Plan the learning activities.
- C. Teach the course, then design tests.
- D. Decide what assessment evidence will show the outcomes were met.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A program preparing for an accreditation visit that falls during a busy flu season builds a curriculum map. The map shows that the program outcome on interprofessional collaboration is not taught or assessed in any course. The program recently hired a new simulation coordinator. What does this indicate?

- A. No problem, because the outcome is written in the program documents.
- B. An alignment gap: courses need outcomes, activities, and assessments that address it.
- C. The new simulation coordinator will cover it automatically.
- D. Delete the outcome to make the map align.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A curriculum committee at a school with a new dean is drafting statements for its BSN program. The committee meets every other Friday. Which statement is written at the level of an end-of-program student learning outcome?

- A. Score 100% on every exam in the program.
- B. Complete 90 clinical hours in medical-surgical nursing.
- C. Integrate evidence, clinical judgment, and patient preferences to provide safe, person-centered care across settings.
- D. Calculate IV drip rates for a pediatric patient in week 3.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A program in a region where the largest employer is a new behavioral health hospital hears from graduates that their mental health skills are weak. The program's gym was recently renovated. When revising the curriculum, which data source is an external frame factor?

- A. Current faculty expertise.
- B. The program's mission statement.
- C. The renovated gym.
- D. Regional workforce needs reported by employers and clinical partners.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which of these is an internal frame factor in curriculum development?

- A.** National accreditation standards.
- B.** Community health needs data.
- C.** State board of nursing regulations.
- D.** The institution's mission and available faculty resources.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A program with overloaded courses, located near a busy highway, reorganizes its curriculum around key concepts such as perfusion and oxygenation and teaches each through a few exemplars instead of every disease. The faculty include 3 new hires. Which approach is this?

- A.** A concept-based curriculum.
- B.** A traditional content-based curriculum.
- C.** Competency-based education.
- D.** Block scheduling.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

What main problem is a concept-based curriculum designed to reduce?

- A.** Too few exemplars per concept.
- B.** Content saturation (curriculum overload).
- C.** Accreditation site visits.
- D.** All need to teach disease-specific content.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A nursing program whose graduates won a statewide poster award uses a systematic evaluation plan listing each outcome, benchmark, data source, responsible person, and timeline. This year the first-time licensure pass rate fell below the 80% benchmark. The program recently changed its logo. What should happen next?

- A.** Analyze the data, carry out an action plan, and reevaluate against the benchmark.
- B.** Wait for the accreditor to raise it.
- C.** Never change the curriculum between accreditation visits.
- D.** Lower the benchmark.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A school revising its curriculum to the 2021 AACN Essentials, located in a city with a new light-rail line, debates how to show that students are ready for practice. The dean likes a traditional semester schedule. Which approach fits competency-based education?

- A.** Pass any student with perfect attendance.
- B.** Count completed credit hours as proof of readiness.
- C.** Students progress by demonstrating defined competencies through authentic assessments.
- D.** Keep the dean's preferred semester schedule as the measure.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In a competency-based program, which evidence best shows a student has attained a competency?

- A.** A performance assessment showing the student meets defined criteria in an authentic setting.
- B.** The student's self-rating of confidence.
- C.** A passing grade in a lecture course.
- D.** The number of clinical hours logged.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A faith-based nursing school ~~with a scenic campus~~ has a mission that emphasizes service to rural and underserved communities. A faculty committee, ~~meeting in the newly renovated library~~, is designing a new BSN elective. Which design choice best reflects the mission?

Target word: mission-aligned design **Decides:** The mission names rural and underserved communities.

A	Adjacent category	Faculty expertise is a resource, not the guiding purpose.
B	Dropped element	Drops the mission from the design.
C	Correct	Curriculum should carry out the stated mission.
D	Camouflage	Campus appearance has nothing to do with curriculum design.

2. Answer B Concept 2

A curriculum team at a college ~~that recently added a parking deck~~ is building a new maternal-newborn course. The team leader, ~~who has 20 years of labor and delivery experience~~, wants to start by choosing favorite case studies. Under backward design, what should the team do first?

Target word: first step of backward design **Decides:** Outcomes come first.

A	Confusion set	Assessment evidence is the second step, after outcomes.
B	Correct	Backward design starts with what students should be able to do.
C	Camouflage	Expertise does not change the design order.
D	Inverted operation	Activities come last in backward design.

3. Answer D Concept 2 · transfer

A team has finished writing its course outcomes. In backward design, what comes next?

Target word: second step **Decides:** Evidence before activities.

A	Adjacent category	Resource selection is part of activity planning, later.
B	Dropped element	Skips the assessment step.
C	Inverted operation	Reverses the backward-design order.
D	Correct	Step two defines acceptable evidence.

4. Answer B Concept 3

A program preparing for an accreditation visit ~~that falls during a busy flu season~~ builds a curriculum map. The map shows that the program outcome on interprofessional collaboration is not taught or assessed in any course. ~~The program recently hired a new simulation coordinator.~~ What does this indicate?

Target word: interpret the map **Decides:** An outcome with no course coverage.

A	Dropped element	Listing an outcome is not teaching or assessing it.
B	Correct	Every program outcome must be taught and assessed.
C	Camouflage	A new hire does not create planned, assessed coverage.
D	Inverted operation	Removes the goal instead of meeting it.

5. Answer C Concept 4

A curriculum committee at a school ~~with a new dean~~ is drafting statements for its BSN program. ~~The committee meets every other Friday.~~ Which statement is written at the level of an end-of-program student learning outcome?

Target word: identify program-level outcome **Decides:** Broad, integrative graduate ability.

A	Absolute language	An unrealistic grade target, not an outcome of learning.
B	Adjacent category	An hours requirement, not a learning outcome.
C	Correct	Broad, integrative, and describes the graduate.
D	Confusion set	A narrow unit-level objective.

6. Answer D Concept 5

A program in a region where the largest employer is a new behavioral health hospital hears from graduates that their mental health skills are weak. ~~The program's gym was recently renovated.~~ When revising the curriculum, which data source is an external frame factor?

Target word: classify frame factor **Decides:** Comes from outside the institution.

A	Confusion set	Faculty are an internal factor.
B	Confusion set	Mission is internal.
C	Camouflage	An internal facility that does not bear on this revision.
D	Correct	Community and workforce needs are external.

7. Answer D Concept 5 • transfer

Which of these is an internal frame factor in curriculum development?

Target word: identify internal **Decides:** Comes from within the institution.

A	Confusion set	Accreditors are outside the institution.
B	Inverted operation	Community needs are external.
C	Inverted operation	Regulation is external.
D	Correct	Mission and resources are internal factors.

8. Answer A Concept 6

A program with overloaded courses, ~~located near a busy highway,~~ reorganizes its curriculum around key concepts such as perfusion and oxygenation and teaches each through a few exemplars instead of every disease. ~~The faculty include 3 new hires.~~ Which approach is this?

Target word: name the approach **Decides:** Concepts taught through exemplars.

A	Correct	Organizing around concepts with exemplars defines it.
B	Inverted operation	Content-based covers each disease separately.
C	Confusion set	CBE is about demonstrating competencies, not how content is organized.
D	Adjacent category	A scheduling format, not a curriculum model.

9. Answer B Concept 6 · transfer

What main problem is a concept-based curriculum designed to reduce?

Target word: purpose — reversed **Decides:** Too much content to cover.

A	Inverted operation	The model deliberately uses a few exemplars.
B	Correct	Exemplars let deep learning replace exhaustive coverage.
C	Adjacent category	Curriculum model does not remove accreditation.
D	Absolute language	Disease content remains through exemplars.

10. Answer A Concept 7

A nursing program ~~whose graduates won a statewide poster award~~ uses a systematic evaluation plan listing each outcome, benchmark, data source, responsible person, and timeline. This year the first-time licensure pass rate fell below the 80% benchmark. ~~The program recently changed its logo.~~ What should happen next?

Target word: respond to a missed benchmark **Decides:** The loop must be closed.

A	Correct	Closing the loop is the purpose of the evaluation plan.
B	Dropped element	Drops the program's own responsibility for ongoing evaluation.
C	Absolute language	Continuous improvement happens between visits.
D	Inverted operation	Moves the target instead of improving results.

11. Answer C Concept 8

A school revising its curriculum to the 2021 AACN Essentials, ~~located in a city with a new light rail line,~~ debates how to show that students are ready for practice. ~~The dean likes a traditional semester schedule.~~ Which approach fits competency-based education?

Target word: how CBE shows readiness **Decides:** Demonstrated competence, not time spent.

A	Absolute language	Attendance does not show competence.
B	Confusion set	Seat time is what CBE moves away from.
C	Correct	CBE ties progression to demonstrated performance.
D	Camouflage	Scheduling does not decide how competence is shown.

12. Answer A Concept 8 · transfer

In a competency-based program, which evidence best shows a student has attained a competency?

Target word: best evidence **Decides:** Performance against defined criteria.

A	Correct	Direct, criterion-based performance is CBE evidence.
B	Adjacent category	Self-assessment is useful but not direct evidence.
C	Dropped element	A course grade may not show the specific competency.
D	Inverted operation	Hours measure time, the input CBE de-emphasizes.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	7	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Mission drives curriculum	Curriculum decisions flow from the institution's mission and philosophy.	Designing around faculty preference or test prep alone.	A mission statement and a design choice.
2	Backward design	Identify desired outcomes → decide acceptable evidence (assessments) → plan learning activities.	Starting with favorite activities or the textbook.	A team starting a new course and a question about what comes first or next.
3	Curriculum alignment and mapping	Each program outcome must be taught and assessed somewhere in the courses; a map reveals gaps.	Assuming an outcome on paper is covered, or deleting it to hide the gap.	A curriculum map with an outcome no course addresses.
4	Program outcomes vs. course objectives	End-of-program outcomes are broad, integrative statements of graduate ability; course and unit objectives are narrower and specific.	Treating a narrow skill or an hours requirement as a program outcome.	Candidate statements at different levels of scope.
5	Internal vs. external frame factors	External factors come from outside the institution (community needs, workforce, regulation, accreditation); internal factors come from within (mission, resources, faculty, students).	Mixing the two lists.	A data source to classify while revising curriculum.
6	Concept-based curriculum	A concept-based curriculum organizes learning around key concepts taught through selected exemplars to reduce content saturation.	Confusing it with competency-based education, or thinking it drops disease content entirely.	Concepts such as perfusion taught through a few exemplars.
7	Systematic evaluation plan	The plan sets benchmarks and data sources; when a benchmark is missed, analyze, act, and reevaluate to close the loop.	Lowering the benchmark or waiting for the accreditor.	A missed benchmark in a systematic evaluation plan.
8	Competency-based education	Students progress by demonstrating defined competencies through authentic assessment, not by seat time or credit hours alone.	Treating hours logged or attendance as proof of competence.	"Ready for practice" and the 2021 AACN Essentials.

Course scope (public description): Contemporary Curriculum Design and Development in Nursing Education analyzes the concepts of creating curriculum based on national nursing accreditation standards and instructional design best practices. Nurse educator students will create course content that supports learning in diverse, real-world environments where nurse educators facilitate learning. Instructional design strategies for delivering course content will reflect the mission of academic institution programs, contemporary trends in nursing education, and the needs of key stakeholders in nursing education and practice. Facilitation of Context-Based Student-Centered Learning is a prerequisite to this course.